We did, and found the place, but Gertrude expended all her eloquence to no avail. There was no paperboard.

We then went down to the Navy Yard, which I now visited for the first time in 9V2 months. It was Gertrude's very first visit.

With my usual caution, and my desire to keep all options open, I asked if I might have a leave of absence to complete my doctoral research. The notion in my mind was this: If, after obtaining my degree, I could not find a job, I might (if I chose to) return to the Navy Yard, at least for a while. That might be preferable to unemployment.

It could be done, I was told, provided I returned, temporarily, to the Navy Yard as an active employee. I drew the line at that. It was too intolerable a way of keeping that option open. I resigned once and for all, 4^/3 years after beginning work there.

We had dinner with Bernie Zitin, Leonard Meisel, and Roy Machlowitz at Shoyer's, Philadelphia's famous Jewish restaurant, which I had eaten at for the first time shortly before induction. Meisel then drove us to Wingate Hall, which we had left nearly a year before, in order to get information concerning some relative of the manager who managed apartments in New York.

Then we took the train back. It was the last whiff of our Philadelphia years.

3

On August 12, we had located a furnished iVi-room apartment, with a closet-kitchenette, that might do. It was distinctly smaller than our Philadelphia apartments and was nearly double the rent—$70 a

month—but it was in New York, not in Philadelphia. In fact, it was on 213 Dean Street, which was within walking distance of the downtown Brooklyn shopping district. That was an undeniably good point.

We had to consider it, and the more we looked elsewhere at altogether impossible places, the more the Dean Street apartment looked reasonable to us.

By August 27, I was so certain that the Dean Street apartment was the best we were going to get that I went to considerable trouble to beat the landlord down to $50 a month by promising to pay him the entire $600 for the year, in advance. The money was paid over on the twenty-ninth and that brought our